

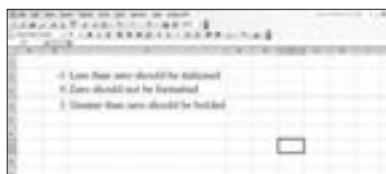
3.4.3.3 Conditional Formatting

Conditional Formatting is one of the features that takes Excel from a simple spreadsheet tool to an application builder. Depending on the value of a cell, you can change the formatting of that cell. Formatting in cells can also be conditional based off of the values in another cell or the results of a calculation. This is done dynamically saving the user the trouble of changing the format themselves.

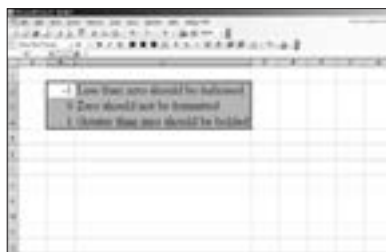
You can use conditional formatting in Excel to track things like invoicing. With conditional formatting, you can tell at a glance which clients owe money and which ones are paid up. You can also use different colouring for charges and deposits.

Here, we will set up cells to be italicised, bolded or left as they are based on whether or not they are less than, greater than, or equal to zero. We'll make cells change colours based off of this condition.

1. Open a new Excel file.
2. Type in some sample numbers in a column. In this sample, we have typed 0, -1, and 1. When we're finished, our sample file will show the conditional formatting in action immediately. In column C, we have typed descriptions on what format the cells should be.
3. Select the cells you want to be affected by the conditional formatting. In this example, we have selected B2, B3, B4, C2, C3, and C4.



The conditional formatting example



First, select the cells you wish to format